



# India's Space Bridge

As the space economy expands beyond ISRO, NewSpace India Ltd is emerging as a commercial lynchpin

BY PALAK AGARWAL

**I**NDIA'S SPACE SECTOR was once defined largely by the capabilities of the Indian Space Research Organisation (ISRO). That picture is changing rapidly. From a single space startup in 2014, India now has more than 300, with private companies entering launch vehicles, satellites, propulsion, earth observation and downstream applications.

The transformation has been aided by the government's 2020 space-sector reforms, which opened the entire value chain to private participation and created the Indian National Space Promotion and Authorisation Centre (IN-SPACe) as the interface between government and industry. Alongside this new architecture, NewSpace India Ltd (NSIL) has been quietly building the commercial bridge between India's public-sector space capabilities and the private market.

Set up in March 2019 as a wholly owned government company under the Department of Space, NSIL was created as ISRO's commercial arm.

After the 2020 reforms, NSIL's role expanded. It received an enhanced mandate to undertake end-to-end commercial space activities on a demand-driven model.

Speaking with *Business Today*, Chairman and Managing Director (Addl Charge) and Director (Finance), Radha Krishna A. says, "For the first time in the history of Indian space program, Indian industry has been entrusted by NSIL with the responsibility to realize launch vehicle on an end-to-end basis. NSIL has enabled Indian industries to develop fully indigenous space products with technical support from ISRO and produce them in bulk to implement on a PAN India level."

NSIL is also moving beyond marketing ISRO's capabilities to building an industrial ecosystem around them. In September 2025, it signed an agreement with ISRO, IN-SPACe and Hindustan Aeronautics Ltd (HAL) to transfer Small Satellite Launch Vehicle (SSLV) tech-



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nology to industry, aiming to create production capacity for the quick-turnaround rocket and tap the growing global small-satellite launch market.

The shift is visible in NSIL's expansion. In February 2026, it opened an office at Gujarat's GIFT City to facilitate international collaboration in launch, satellite and mission-support services.

With India's space economy targeted to grow from about \$8.4 billion to \$44 billion by 2033, NSIL sits at a vital intersection. **BT**

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